Phase 1 | Brainstorming & Ideation

Empathy Map

AI-Powered Travel Planner | Smart Situational Itinerary Engine

Live URL:	https://travel-planner-iota-plum.vercel.
GitHub:	github.com/itskian2007/travel-planner
Tech:	React + FastAPI + PostgreSQL + Vercel
Team:	itskian2007

1. User Persona Overview

The primary user persona is "Aarav" - a 27-year-old tech-savvy professional who travels 3-4 times a year for leisure. Secondary personas include a 45-year-old family traveller and a 22-year-old budget backpacker. All personas share frustration with fragmented travel planning.

AARAV, 27

Software Engineer

Bangalore, India

Travels 3-4x/year

Goals:

- Stress-free trip planning
- Personalised recommendations
- Value for money
- Authentic local experiences

2. Empathy Map - 4 Quadrant Analysis

THINKS & FEELS

"I wish planning was easier"

"What if I miss something?"

"This is taking too long"

"I want a perfect trip"

"Budget anxiety"

HEARS

"Friends recommend apps"

Travel blogs & vlogs

Social media destination posts

Word of mouth reviews

Influencer itineraries

SEES

Conflicting travel guides

Generic itinerary templates

Overwhelming booking sites

Beautiful destination reels

Friends trip posts

SAYS & DOES

Googles "best places in X"

Watches 10+ YouTube videos

Asks friends for advice

Books last minute

Creates manual spreadsheet

- Wastes 4-8 hrs on research

- Generic, irrelevant itineraries

- No dietary/accessibility filters

- Inauthentic or misleading images

- Re-planning due to poor first plans

GAINS

- Gets personalised itinerary in seconds
- Filters by mood, budget, diet & persona
- Sees 304 verified landmark images
- Day 1-3 curated + Day 4-10 auto-generated
- One platform for all 20 global destinations